

Ministry of Forests, Lands and Natural Resource Operations

BC River Forecast Centre

Flood Watch: Upper Fraser River

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The BC River Forecast Centre is **issuing a Flood Watch** for:

- Upper Fraser River (at Prince George and upstream)

Snowmelt has been rapid over the past week as a result of unseasonably high temperatures. Additional rainfall over the past day is causing a sharp rise in the tributaries (e.g. Dore River, McGregor River). Additional rainfall is expected over the next day, with 10 mm or more of rain forecast through most of the watershed.

The McGregor River at Lower Canyon (WSC Gauge 08KB003) has risen sharply over the past 24-hours, and is currently flowing at 1610 m³/s (10-year flow). The Fraser River at Hansard (08KA004) is flowing at 1750 m³/s (approaching a 2-year flow), Fraser River at Shelley (08KB001) is flowing at 3455 m³/s (between a 2-year and 5-year flow) and the Fraser River at South Fort George (08KE018) is currently at 8.67m.

River levels are expected to continue to rise sharply through Tuesday. The Fraser River at South Fort George is forecast to reach approximately 9.2m by late Monday evening. There may be significant additional rises Tuesday and Wednesday if precipitation is heavy in the upper watershed.

The River Forecast Centre will continue to monitor conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.